



Google Chat Bots can be a lot of fun



Finding those who are lost:

Google People Finder is Google's initiative to help people in times of crisis when families and loved ones are separated from each other. When there is a major natural crisis, GPF creates a database of information provided by organizations and people in general in case they find someone who has been lost in the chaos. This information is available online for people looking for their loved ones, possibly from the other side of the globe. Currently GPF has been running databases on people still missing in Japan as well as the casualties of Typhoon Yolanda in the Philippines. It's an admirable effort, and seems to be quite effective in its own right. It may not always have good news, but it does offer closure to people who have lost track of their family and loved ones in crises, one way or the other <http://dg.it./googlepeoplefinder>

As mentioned before, Google's come quite far from the search engine it used to be. Over time, it has expanded to occupying a more prominent space in modern culture. It has captured the trust and (almost blind) faith of people all over. Quite the street cred.

DISINFECTING YOUR PC

So we've all had this problem. At some point of time in life. Computers have their own shelf

life, but virus and malware issues cut that time exponentially. Even if you follow preventive measures to the letter, computer viruses are so named because they have the knack of evolving faster than people can



There's always a danger of getting infected

find a way to counteract them. They are a seemingly never-dying breed, but then it's an occupational hazard that comes with owning technology.



First prevent infection

Preventing infection is easiest with a brand new machine. It's even easier if you decide to keep your computer completely isolated. Don't connect it to the internet. Don't plug it to an external hard drive or pen drive. Don't install anything on it from any external source. If that is the case, stop reading this article right here. You're doing everything right with respect to owning a completely uninfected computer. If, however, your PC is more than just an expensive paperweight, read on.

The first thing you do when you get a new computer is get a good antivirus. Now you can choose to go for a paid solution but free ones such as Avast are good as well.

Install the antivirus on the PC, then update it online. Your first line of defence is set, more or less. This should take care of most of the problems you may have faced early in the game.

Avoid downloading anything that you know nothing about. There's a lot of free-ware out there that is riddled with viruses piggybacking on them. When installing a new program, make sure you don't install any add-on software unintentionally. Usually these add-on extra software are listed as options in the install process, with boxes prematurely checked and ready. Go through individual steps of the install procedures, instead of just clicking 'yes'

and 'next' throughout to hasten the process.

Try verifying the safety of a website before you visit it. Yes, the antivirus is supposed to block malicious online content, and it certainly does, but you need to remember that everything, including your awesome, antivirus isn't infallible.

The most important advice of all: watch what you download. A lot of the Trojans and other malware that make their way to your PC are a result of zero vigilance. Keep your eyes open when downloading off ANYWHERE from the internet. You never know what's infected.



Establish cause and effect

How do you know if you've been infected? First off, verify that it is indeed an infection that is plaguing your PC. There have been several scenarios where people say 'My computer is infected, but on further examination, the 'infection' turns out to be faulty hardware or badly installed firmware. Cross out the less dramatic options before you jump to the conclusion that your PC is, indeed, infected.



Read the signs

There are some distinct signs that would indicate



Invest in a premium antivirus